

Word family: **stress / stressed / stressful / stressing / stressor / stress-free / stress-related**

Base word: stress

Verb forms: stress, stresses, stressed, stressing

Related forms: stressful, stressed, stressor

Useful extensions: stress-free, stress-related, stress test

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “The ad showed ordinary people in **stressful** places, such as a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy office.”

A full family sweep shows that **stress** is a particularly rich word because it crosses several domains:

- * emotional/psychological pressure;
- * physical strain on the body;
- * emphasis placed on an idea;
- * linguistic word/syllable stress;
- * engineering/physics stress;
- * medical/biological stress;
- * testing something under difficult conditions.

The core idea running through many of these is:

> **pressure, force, or extra importance being placed on something.**

Meaning in your passage

Here, **stressful** means:

causing mental tension, pressure, tiredness, or difficulty relaxing.

The packed train, busy café, and noisy office are environments that can make a person feel mentally overloaded or tense.

繁體中文: **容易令人產生心理壓力、緊張、疲累或難以放鬆的**

Natural translation:

> “The ad showed ordinary people in stressful places...”

「廣告展示了一些身處**令人感到壓力和緊張的環境**中的普通人.....」

So here:

****stressful = 會造成心理壓力、緊張或精神負擔的****

1. ****stress = mental/emotional pressure (心理／情緒) — 壓力;精神壓力****

This is the central everyday noun meaning behind ****stressful****.

Practice 1

> “Work has been causing me a lot of ****stress**** lately.”

「最近工作給我帶來很大的****精神壓力****。」

Practice 2

> “Too much ****stress**** can affect sleep.”

「過多的****壓力****可能影響睡眠。」

****stress = 因工作、責任、困難或威脅而產生的心理緊張、精神負擔或壓迫感****

2. ****stress = physical strain on the body (身體) — 身體負擔;壓力****

****Meaning:**** Physical demand or strain placed on the body or part of the body.

Practice 3

> “Running on hard surfaces can put ****stress**** on the knees.”

「在硬地面跑步可能會對膝蓋造成****身體負擔／壓力****。」

Practice 4

> “Poor posture places extra ****stress**** on the lower back.”

「不良姿勢會令下背部承受額外的****壓力和負擔****。」

****stress — physical = 身體或某個部位因受力、重複動作或負荷而承受的額外負擔****

This is related to psychological stress, but the pressure is now physical.

3. **stress** = emphasis/importance (觀點／內容) — 強調; 著重

Here, **stress** is a noun referring to special emphasis.

Practice 5

> “The course places particular **stress** on practical skills.”

「這個課程特別**著重實用技能**。」

Practice 6

> “The report puts more **stress** on prevention.”

「這份報告更加**強調預防的重要性**。」

stress = 對某個觀點、原則或部分給予比其他內容更多的重視和強調

4. **stress** + point/importance/need (動詞) — 強調; 著重指出

This is a major verb meaning.

Practice 7

> “The teacher **stressed** the importance of checking your work.”

「老師**強調**檢查自己功課的重要性。」

Practice 8

> “The report **stresses** the need for better safety measures.”

「報告**強調**需要更完善的安全措施。」

stress something = 特別指出某件事很重要, 希望別人特別留意或重視

This has nothing to do with feeling anxious in these sentences.

5. **stress + person(動詞) — 令某人感到壓力／焦慮**

Practice 9

> “Deadlines **stress** me.”

「截止日期會令我**感到很大壓力**。」

Practice 10

> “The constant noise was **stressing** everyone.”

「持續的噪音令所有人都**感到精神緊張和有壓力**。」

stress someone = 令某人產生心理壓力、焦慮或精神緊張

This is the verb corresponding to psychological **stress**.

6. **stressful = situation/place/job(情況／地方／工作)causing stress — 令人有壓力的; 緊張的**

This is your original form.

Practice 11 — Original context

> “The ad showed ordinary people in **stressful** places.”

「廣告展示普通人身處**令人感到壓力的環境**。」

Practice 12

> “Moving house can be very **stressful**.”

「搬屋可以是一件非常**令人有壓力、令人疲累緊張的事情**。」

Practice 13

> “She has a **stressful** job.”

「她的工作**壓力很大、很容易令人緊張疲累**。」

****stressful = 本身會造成心理壓力、焦慮或精神負擔的****

7. ****stressed = person feeling stress(人) — 感到有壓力的; 緊張疲累的****

This distinction is essential.

Practice 14

> “I felt ****stressed**** after a long day at work.”

「工作了一整天後, 我感到****壓力很大、很緊張疲累****。」

Practice 15

> “She looks ****stressed****.”

「她看起來****壓力很大／精神很緊張****。」

****stressed = 某人正在承受心理壓力、緊張或精神負擔的****

Critical distinction: ****stressful vs stressed****

This is one of the most important contrasts in the family.

****stressful****

describes the ****thing causing the pressure****.

> “The journey was stressful.”

「旅程令人感到壓力很大。」

****stressed****

describes the ****person experiencing the pressure****.

> “I was stressed.”

「我感到壓力很大。」

So:

> **stressful job** = 令人有壓力的工作

> **stressed worker** = 感到壓力很大的員工

Exactly like:

* exhausting → 令人疲累

* exhausted → 感到筋疲力盡

8. **stressed** = word/syllable receiving emphasis (語言) — 重讀的; 有重音的

This is a genuinely distinct linguistic meaning.

Practice 16

> “The first syllable is **stressed**.”

「第一個音節是**重讀的**／帶主重音的。」

Practice 17

> “Content words are often **stressed** in English sentences.”

「英語句子中的實詞通常會被**重讀**。」

stressed — linguistics = 發音時比附近其他音節／詞更突出、更有重音的

9. **stress** = pronunciation emphasis (語音) — 重音

Here, **stress** is a linguistic noun.

Practice 18

> “The word has **stress** on the second syllable.”

「這個字的**重音**在第二個音節。」

Practice 19

> “Changing the **stress** can affect how natural the sentence sounds.”

「改變**重音位置**可能影響句子聽起來是否自然。」

stress — linguistics = 說話時對某個音節或詞給予較強、較突出發音的現象

10. **stress + syllable/word** (語言動詞) — 重讀; 把重音放在.....

Practice 20

> “**Stress** the first syllable.”

「請**重讀第一個音節**。」

Practice 21

> “Native speakers often **stress** the key word.”

「母語者常會**重讀關鍵字詞**。」

stress — pronunciation verb = 發音時有意把某個音節或詞讀得更突出

This is technically related to “emphasize,” but in language learning it is specialized enough to teach explicitly.

11. **stress = force per unit area** (工程／物理) — 應力

This is a genuinely distinct technical meaning.

Meaning: Internal force experienced by a material when an external force acts on it.

Practice 22

> “Engineers calculated the **stress** on the beam.”

「工程師計算了橫樑所承受的**應力**。」

Practice 23

> “The material can withstand high levels of **stress**.”

「這種材料能承受很高的**應力**。」

****stress — engineering/physics = 材料受到外力時, 其內部單位面積所承受的力／應力****

12. ****stressed = material/structure under force (材料／結構) — 受應力的; 受力的****

Practice 24

> “The ****stressed**** section of the structure needs reinforcement.”

「結構中****承受較大應力的部分****需要加固。」

Practice 25

> “Cracks appeared in highly ****stressed**** areas.”

「裂縫出現在****承受高度應力的區域****。」

****stressed — engineering = 正承受機械應力或較大物理負荷的****

This is completely different from “a stressed employee.”

13. ****stress = biological/medical strain (生理／生物) — 應激; 生理壓力****

In biology and medicine, ****stress**** can refer more broadly to physiological strain caused by challenging conditions.

Practice 26

> “Heat ****stress**** can affect the body.”

「高溫****應激／熱壓力****可能影響身體。」

Practice 27

> “Plants experience water ****stress**** during drought.”

「植物在乾旱期間會出現水分不足造成的****逆境壓力／水分應激****。」

****stress — biological = 生物面對高溫、缺水、疾病等不利條件時產生的生理負荷／應激反應****

This is more technical than ordinary psychological stress but still useful.

14. **stressor = thing that causes stress — 壓力來源; 應激源**

An important family member.

Practice 28

> “Noise is a common workplace **stressor**.”

「噪音是常見的職場**壓力來源**。」

Practice 29

> “Financial problems can be major **stressors**.”

「財務問題可能是很大的**壓力來源**。」

stressor = 會引起心理、生理或生物壓力反應的因素／刺激

This is more formal than saying:

> source of stress

15. **stress-related = caused by or associated with stress — 與壓力有關的; 由壓力引起的**

Practice 30

> “She took time off because of **stress-related** health problems.”

「她因為**與壓力有關的健康問題**而請假。」

Practice 31

> “The company introduced measures to reduce **stress-related** absence.”

「公司推出措施, 希望減少**因壓力問題造成的缺勤**。」

stress-related = 與壓力有直接關係或可能由壓力造成的

16. **stress-free = without significant stress — 無壓力的;輕鬆的**

Practice 32

> “They wanted a more **stress-free** journey.”

「他們希望旅程可以更加**輕鬆、沒有太大壓力**。」

Practice 33

> “Online check-in can make travelling more **stress-free**.”

「網上辦理登機可以令旅行過程更加**輕鬆省心**。」

stress-free = 幾乎沒有心理壓力、緊張或麻煩的

It usually does not mean literally zero stress; it often means **relatively easy and relaxed**.

17. **stress test = test under difficult/heavy conditions (系統／產品／身體) — 壓力測試; 負荷測試**

A very useful compound because it appears across several domains.

Practice 34

> “The engineers performed a **stress test** on the system.”

「工程師對系統進行了**壓力測試／負荷測試**。」

Practice 35

> “The bank passed the financial **stress test**.”

「這間銀行通過了金融**壓力測試**。」

stress test = 刻意施加極端或困難條件，以檢查系統、機構或物件能否承受壓力的測試

18. **stress test (醫療) — 運動心臟負荷測試／心臟壓力測試**

Same phrase, specialized medical context.

Practice 36

> “The doctor recommended a cardiac **stress test**.”

「醫生建議進行**心臟負荷測試**。」

Practice 37

> “The **stress test** measures how the heart performs during exercise.”

「**心臟負荷測試**用來測量運動時心臟的表現。」

stress test — medical = 透過運動或藥物增加心臟負荷，以觀察心臟功能的檢查

19. **stress-test** = deliberately test under demanding conditions (動詞) — 進行壓力測試

Practice 38

> “The developers **stress-tested** the software before release.”

「開發人員在發布前對軟件進行了**壓力測試**。」

Practice 39

> “The new bridge was **stress-tested** before opening.”

「新橋在開放前接受了**承載／壓力測試**。」

stress-test = 刻意在高負荷或極端條件下測試某物的穩定性和承受能力

Important distinction: **stress** vs **pressure**

These overlap strongly but are not identical.

stress

often emphasizes the emotional/physical reaction or burden.

pressure

often emphasizes demands or forces being placed on someone.

> “I’m under a lot of pressure at work.”

「工作對我有很大壓力。」

> “I’m feeling stressed.”

「我感到很有壓力。」

A useful simplification:

pressure = 外在要求／壓力來源

stress = 因這些要求而產生的身心緊張

But real usage overlaps.

Important distinction: **stress vs anxiety**

stress

often has an identifiable external cause:

* workload

* noise

* deadline

anxiety

means worry/fear/nervousness and may continue even without an immediate external demand.

> “The deadline is causing stress.”

「截止期限帶來壓力。」

> “She feels anxious about the future.”

「她對未來感到焦慮。」

They can occur together but are not synonyms.

Important distinction: ****stressful vs difficult****

****difficult****

= hard to do/deal with.

****stressful****

= causes mental pressure, tension, or emotional strain.

Something can be:

> difficult but not stressful

for example, an enjoyable puzzle.

Or:

> stressful but not technically difficult

for example, waiting for important news.

Important distinction: ****stressful vs exhausting****

You curated ****exhausting/exhausted**** earlier.

****stressful****

= creates mental/emotional pressure.

****exhausting****

= makes you extremely tired.

> “The meeting was stressful.”

「會議令人壓力很大。」

> “The hike was exhausting.”

「遠足令人筋疲力盡。」

A situation can be both.

Important distinction: **stressed** vs **exhausted**

stressed

= psychologically under pressure.

exhausted

= extremely tired physically or mentally.

In your passage, the commuting environment is:

> **stressful**

and the speaker gets home:

> **exhausted**

That contrast is excellent:

environment → stressful

person after enduring it → stressed/exhausted

Important distinction: **stressful** vs **stressed**

Worth repeating because this is the classic learner trap:

> **a stressful office**

> = 一個令人感到壓力的辦公室

> **a stressed employee**

> = 一個感到壓力很大的員工

Not:

> *a stressed office* if you mean the office causes stress.

Although ****stressed system/material**** can have other technical meanings.

Important distinction: **stress vs emphasize**

For the verb meaning:

**stress**

= strongly emphasize something as important.

**emphasize**

= neutral/formal general verb meaning give special importance.

> “The teacher stressed the importance of revision.”

> “The teacher emphasized the importance of revision.”

Both are natural.

****Stress**** can sound slightly stronger.

Important distinction: **stress vs accent (linguistics)**

**stress**

= prominence given to a syllable or word through greater force, duration, pitch, etc.

**accent**

can mean:

* a regional/social way of pronouncing;

* in some contexts, prominence/stress.

For learners, it is safer to distinguish:

> **word stress** = 單字重音

> **British accent** = 英國口音

Important distinction: stress vs strain

stress

= pressure/force or psychological burden.

strain

often emphasizes the damage or difficulty caused by sustained stress.

> “The job causes stress.”

「工作帶來壓力。」

> “The long hours put a strain on their relationship.”

「長時間工作對他們的關係造成負擔。」

In engineering, **stress** and **strain** are also distinct technical concepts:

* **stress** = force per unit area

* **strain** = deformation relative to original size

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

* **stress — psychological** = 心理／精神壓力

* **stress — physical** = 身體負擔

* **stress — emphasis** = 強調／重視

* **stress — verb: emphasize** = 強調

* **stress someone** = 令某人有壓力

* **stressful** = 令人產生壓力的

* **stressed — emotional** = 感到壓力很大的

* **stress — linguistics** = 重音

* **stressed syllable/word** = 重讀音節／詞

* **stress — engineering** = 應力

* **stressed material** * = 承受應力的材料
 * **stress — biological** * = 生理／生物應激
 * **stressor** * = 壓力來源／應激源
 * **stress-related** * = 與壓力有關的
 * **stress-free** * = 輕鬆、低壓力的
 * **stress test** * = 壓力／負荷測試
 * **stress-test** * = 對.....進行壓力測試

I would **not** expand **stress out** because phrasal verbs remain excluded by default under our standing rule.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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stress — psychological	因責任、困難或威脅而產生的心理緊張和精神負擔
stress — physical body	身體或某部位因受力、負荷或重複動作而承受的額外負擔
stress — emphasis	對某個觀點、原則或部分給予特別重視
stress — verb: emphasize	特別指出某件事情的重要性, 希望別人留意
stress someone	令某人產生心理壓力、焦慮或精神緊張
stressful	本身會造成心理壓力、焦慮或精神負擔的
stressed — emotional	正在承受心理壓力、緊張或精神負擔的
stress — linguistics	發音時令某個音節／詞比其他部分更加突出／重讀的現象
stressed — linguistics	在發音時承受重音、被特別重讀的
stress — engineering	材料受到外力時內部單位面積所承受的力／應力
stressed — engineering	正承受機械應力或較大物理負荷的
stress — biological	生物面對不利條件時產生的生理負荷／應激反應
stressor	會引起心理、生理或生物壓力反應的因素
stress-related	與壓力直接相關或可能由壓力造成的
stress-free	幾乎沒有心理壓力、緊張或麻煩的
stress test	在極端／高負荷條件下檢查承受能力的測試; 醫療上亦可指心臟負荷測試
stress-test	刻意在高負荷或極端條件下測試某物是否穩定可靠

For your original sentence

> “The ad showed ordinary people in **stressful places**...”

The exact meaning is:

stressful = 那些地方的噪音、擠迫、人流和忙碌程度會令人產生心理壓力、疲累和難以放鬆的感覺

So naturally:

> ****stressful places****

= ****「令人感到壓力的環境／容易令人精神緊張的地方」****

And the crucial family contrast is:

> ****The place is stressful.****

> 地方令人有壓力。

> ****The person is stressed.****

> 那個人感到很有壓力。